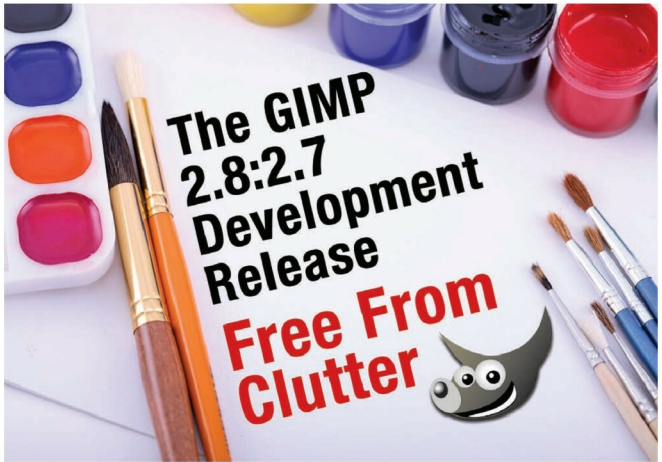




The GIMP version 2.6 was released two years back, and it's time for us to embrace a new development series of the GIMP Dubbed as 2.8:2.7, the FOSS editing software is finally getting a much-needed makeover, to make it more profound and exploitable.

The venerable and most powerful open source image editing software, the GIMP, is out with a new development release, and it is brimming with new features. The new release is a milestone in the FOSS graphics editing world. With the Libre Graphics Meeting over, the GIMP developers have laid out a roadmap and deadline for the upcoming stable release. Like other graphics editing software, the GIMP has an odd release number for testing candidates, and an even number for the stable release. Major changes and feature sets are pushed into odd-numbered releases, while the stable releases provide only bug fixes.

Unlike the GIMP 2.6, the upcoming release will focus more on cosmetic changes, rather than on the core of the system. It features the first-ever complete (yet optional) UI redesign,

with a single-windowed mode, along with layer grouping, brush rotation and other nifty features. With such major UI changes, the developers are determined to remove the perplexities of the old UI, which were a major barrier to mass adoption. In addition, the GIMP 2.8 will bring deeper GEGL integration, though the release will still lack CMYK and high-bit colour channel support 'out of the box'.

The main reason for the makeover was the general lack of usability, which was often considered to be a barrier. With the confusing assortment of windows and the floating toolbar, the cluttered interface of the GIMP 2.6 is too perplexing for newbies and professionals alike. After intensive brainstorming and subjecting the GIMP to major analysis, the developers have attempted to make the interface more usable and intuitive.